

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 6

♣ 9 7 5 4 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ A 6

♦ Q 9 8 4 2

♣ K Q J



♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 3

♦ A 7

♣ A 10 8 6

♠ 8 7

♥ Q J 9 8 4

♦ K J 10 5 3

♣ 2

West

North

East

South

1♣

2NT

Pass

4♦

All Pass

4♦ by North

Lead: ♦ A

The bidding has been as shown.

With the two lowest unbid suits you bid 2NT. Partner jumps to 4♦.

Partner probably has a good hand, but he might just be preempting. Assuming he is inviting you to bid game you have a tough decision. You are not very strong but you might have been a couple of points weaker. It is strictly a judgement call and we decide to pass.

As you can see, **IF** they open the lead with a ♣, and **IF** the ♥ finesse then works, you can make 5♦.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 7 4
 ♥ Q J 10 9 6
 ♦ 5
 ♣ 7 4

♠ Q 5 3 2

♥ K 2

♦ K J 10 2

♣ J 3 2



♠ A J 10 6

♥ 7 4

♦ A 7 6

♣ A 10 9 5

♠ —

♥ A 8 5 3

♦ Q 9 8 4 3

♣ K Q 8 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
2♦	Pass	3♠	1♦
4♠			Pass
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♦3			

The bidding has been as shown.

As you have figured out by now, using Michaels Cue-Bids / Unusual Notrump is sometimes hard to tie down. Here you have 13/14 points and if you figure partner for 9 that won't be enough for game. But, those two Minor Aces are worth a lot when you figure partner has only 3 Minor suit cards.

So let's say you decide to just invite with 3♠. Partner takes you to game.

You will surely make this game if trumps split 2-2. If they don't then you will have to hope for a defensive mistake.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ K 10 7 3 2
 ♦ —
 ♣ Q 10 9 7 3

♠ K Q J 7
 ♥ 6
 ♦ 9 7 4
 ♣ K 8 6 5 4



♠ A 9 8 4 3
 ♥ A 5
 ♦ A Q 8 6 2
 ♣ A

♠ 10
 ♥ Q J 9 8 4
 ♦ K J 10 5 3
 ♣ J 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♠	2 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
All Pass			
3 ♦ by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

The bidding has been as shown.

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor you bid 2 ♠, Michaels of course. Partner bids 2NT. What do you say next?

Is it possible that partner wants to play Notrump? Not at all. He hates ♥s and wants you to bid your Minor suit. So you say 3 ♦ and he passes.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 6
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ K 7 6 3
 ♣ A 10 9 6 5

♠ A 9 8 2

♥ J 5

♦ A 9 2

♣ Q 8 7 2



♠ K Q

♥ A K Q 8 3

♦ Q J 10 5 4

♣ 3

♠ J 7 5 4 3

♥ 10 9 6 2

♦ 8

♣ K J 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

2NT

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

5 ♦

All Pass

5 ♦ by West

Lead: ♣ 7

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner asked you to choose between ♥s and ♦s so you bid 3 ♦. He then raises you to 4 ♦.

If you say to yourself "I only have 7 HCP" then you might pass. But if you say "Partner invited me to bid game, even though I might have no points and only 3 trumps. I'm a lot better than that.", then you will accept the invitation. So you bid 5 ♦ and everybody passes.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A Q 8 7 4 3
♦ 7
♣ A J 8 7

♠ A Q J 6 5
♥ 9
♦ A Q 10 5 3
♣ 6 3



♠ 7 2
♥ K 10
♦ J 9 8 4 2
♣ 10 9 4 2

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ J 6 5 2
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♥K			

The bidding has been as shown.

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor suit this looks like an ideal Michaels Cue-Bid, right? No, not really. While it would not be a capital offense to bid 2♥ here, it generally works out better with 13-16 point hands to just overcall in your higher-ranking suit. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 2♥.

Partner's cue-bid shows a limit-raise or better in ♠s. So you bid 4♠ without the blink of an eye.

Board 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 6 4 2
♦ K 10 9 3
♣ K 8 6 5

♠ K 7
♥ A J 9 7 5
♦ Q J 6 4
♣ 9 2



♠ A 10 9 8 3
♥ 8
♦ 7 5
♣ Q J 10 7 4

♠ Q J 5 4 2
♥ Q 10 3
♦ A 8 2
♣ A 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	2♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	
All Pass			
3♣ by East			
Lead: ♥3			

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner is 5-5 in ♠s and one of the Minor suits.
Forget ♠s, you want him to bid the Minor. So you bid 2NT. Partner says 3♣.

Partner only made a minimum bid, so you have no choice but to pass.